Brand Guide — NCEES Exam Prep App Family

Version · v0.2.6 — 2026-10-24

Parent documents · Vision & Build Plan v0.1.0 (§4); Aesthetic Styles v0.1.0 (2026-10-17)

Status · **Style C "Calm Pro" chosen 2026-10-18; D2 icon system completed 2026-10-19** (C3 field monogram + per-exam glyphs; per-exam icon fields kept — §2.3). This version supersedes the v0.1.0 hi-vis system (§2 rewritten). **D1 DECIDED 2026-10-24: family name = "Benchmark Prep" (§1).** All colors final, FE/PE assignment reaffirmed 2026-10-19 (see Revision history).

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1. Naming system

Unchanged from v0.1.0.

- **Pattern (binding):** `<FamilyName> <EXAM>` — family name decided 2026-10-24: **Benchmark Prep**. Titles: *Benchmark Prep FS*, *Benchmark Prep PS*, *Benchmark Prep FE*, *Benchmark Prep PE*; state PLS apps: *Benchmark Prep PLS* (e.g., *Benchmark Prep PLS NY*). Store subtitles carry the plain descriptor: "Fundamentals of Surveying Exam Prep," etc.
- **Decision record (D1, 2026-10-24):** Charlie holds "Benchmark Prep" as the family name, chosen with the collision findings on record: benchmarkprep.com is an active SAT/ACT prep company trading as "BenchmarkPrep," and BenchPrep (benchprep.com) is a major exam-prep platform that partners with NCEES. The §1 criterion "trademark-clear and .com-able" is knowingly waived by the decider for the display name. The permanent store identity is deliberately decoupled from the name: applicationIds use `com.crieck.prep.*` (FS = `com.crieck.prep.fs`, decided 2026-10-24), so a future name change would cost a listing edit, not an identity.
- **Name criteria (historical, for the record):** says "licensure/field professional" without saying "NCEES"; works

for both surveyors and engineers; trademark-clear and .com-able; short enough to sit beside a two-letter exam code; sounds like a tool a professional would keep on their phone for years.

2. Visual identity — Calm Pro

A quiet, premium study desk. Warm neutrals, one muted accent, generous whitespace, almost no chrome — the content is the interface. Built for adults spending real money on a license: trust and readability outrank decoration, and gamification is presented as plain information, never as noise.

2.1 Palette (design tokens — implement identically in every app)

Token · Light · Dark · Use

`bg` · #FAFAF8 · #17181A · App background (warm white / warm charcoal)

`surface` · #FFFFFF · #1F2023 · Cards, sheets, tab bar

`ink` · #1C1B1A · #EDEAE4 · Primary text

`steel` · #6E6A63 · #9B968C · Secondary text, captions

`divider` · #E7E2D9 · #2C2D30 · Hairlines — structure comes from dividers, not boxes

`accent` · #0F766E · #0F766E · Primary actions (buttons) in both modes; white text on it

`accentBright` · #0F766E · #5EC8B8 · Dark-mode accent text, progress rings/bars, active tab

`go` · #2F7D5B · #6FBF92 · Correct / mastery positive

`warn` · #B0483E · #E08A7E · Incorrect / attention (muted, never alarming)

Per-exam accents (same muted register; used for that app's header mark, progress ring, and icon detail — never to recolor primary actions family-wide):

Exam · Accent · Note

FS · #0F766E deep teal · FS uses the family accent directly

PS · #2E4B34 deep pine · Green family with FS — the NCEES surveying line reads green: FS teal → PS pine (changed 2026-10-19)

FE · #2F5D8A slate blue · Muted successor to signal blue

PE · #A03E38 brick · Muted successor to iron red

State PLS · #6B5433 deep bronze · The brass benchmark/monument color (decided 2026-10-19); one shared field/accent for all state apps; icon letters = state abbreviation (NY, CA, …)

Color decisions (2026-10-19): State PLS = **deep bronze

6B5433**, replacing ink #26282C (Charlie: ink read too dark on

a home screen; bronze is the brass benchmark/monument color). Also, PS = **deep pine #2E4B34**, replacing terracotta #B4552D, so the NCEES surveying line reads as one green family (FS teal → PS pine). Other candidate considered for state: warm graphite

4A4A45. Terracotta #B4552D retires from the active palette.

2.2 Typography

- UI font: platform Material 3 default stack (Roboto on Android).
- Display font: **Noto Serif** — Study Guide headlines, section headings in Learn, empty-state headlines. Never for buttons, chrome, or body text.
- Type scale: Material 3 defaults. Minimum body size 16sp. Math and formulas render at ≥ body size with generous line height.
- Numerals: tabular figures for all stats, scores, timers, and counts (no jitter as numbers change).

2.3 Components & icon system

- Corner radius 6–8dp. **No shadows, no elevation, no decorative gradients.** Flat surfaces separated by hairline dividers.
- Progress is thin bars and plain numbers. Streaks, badges, and leaderboards render as muted line-icon rows and plain ranked lists — information, not arcade art.
- **Icon (D2 — decided 2026-10-19, complete):** solid field in the exam's accent. **Per-exam icon fields are kept** — an all-teal icon set was proofed and declined 2026-10-19; teal's unifying role is in-app (primary actions, §2.1), while field color differentiates the apps on home screens and store shelves and threads into each app's accent layer. The exam's two letters sit in paper #FAFAF8, serif (Noto Serif class); above them, one **per-exam glyph in the same paper tone** — never a third color, and never ink (ink sinks on the mid-tone fields). Glyphs share one grammar — a simple outline mark with a center point, matched size, weight, and position:
- **FS · PS · state PLS: benchmark triangle, outline with center dot (△)** — the control-point glyph; the surveying line.
- **FE: gear, outline with hub dot** — engineering fundamentals.
- **PE: rosette seal** — scalloped seal silhouette with a **generous open center, roughly half the glyph's diameter** (enlarged twice at Charlie's direction, 2026-10-19, so the mark reads as a ring seal); the licensed engineer's stamp (Charlie's pick). State PLS icons: shared deep bronze field #6B5433, letters = state abbreviation. Same grid, radius, and letter weight across the whole set — siblings on a home screen. Production icons are drawn as one matched vector set, glyph weights balanced so every mark survives 48px launcher rendering; the AI renders on file are concepts.
- **Never** use NCEES marks, state seals, or anything implying official endorsement — in icons, listings, or screenshots.

2.4 Color modes

- SYSTEM / LIGHT / DARK all supported; **System is the default.** The app must follow the user's selected mode — never force dark.
- Light is the lead mode (designed first); dark is a true palette translation, not an inversion.

3. Voice & copy

Unchanged from v0.1.0.

- **Plain, direct, field-professional.** Short sentences, correct terminology, no hype.
- Encouraging through competence, not cheerleading: "Boundary Law is up 12 points this week" — never "You're crushing it, rockstar!"
- Numbers over adjectives. Streaks inform; they never shame.
- Error and empty states explain what happened and the next step, in that order.
- All pricing copy states the window and terms in the same sentence as the price.

4. Store & listing presentation

- Screenshot sets share one template: device frame, **paper background, ink headline, thin per-exam accent rule** (replaces the v0.1.0 charcoal/yellow template).
- Listing order of claims: diagnostic → bank depth → spaced repetition → worked solutions → offline. Never lead with price.
- Disclaimer line in every listing and in-app About: *"Independent study tool. Not affiliated with or endorsed by NCEES. NCEES, FS, PS, FE, and PE are marks of the National Council of Examiners for Engineering and Surveying."* [Verify exact mark language with the current NCEES guidance at listing time.]

5. What agents must never do

- Invent a family name, tagline, or logo variant.
- Introduce a new color, font, or icon style without a Brand Guide revision approved by Charlie. In particular: no accent hues outside the §2.1 muted set, and no shadows or gradients reintroduced "for polish."
- Use official-looking seals, "official," "NCEES-approved," or pass-rate claims anywhere. Pass-rate claims require real data and Charlie's written approval — until then, none.

Revision history

- **v0.2.6 (2026-10-24):** D1 decided — family name = "Benchmark Prep" (held by Charlie with the

benchmarkprep.com / BenchPrep collision findings documented in §1; the trademark-clear/.com-able criterion knowingly waived for the display name). applicationId family decoupled: `com.crieck.prep.*`. §1 rewritten as the decided state; no visual-identity changes.

- **v0.2.5 (2026-10-19):** Record-only — palette unchanged. Charlie reconsidered the FE/PE assignment and reaffirmed it (Option A): FE stays slate blue #2F5D8A, PE stays brick #A03E38. Alternatives proofed and set aside: PE terracotta (complementary-pair logic) and PE slate blue with FE brick (flagship-blue logic). Rationale kept: cool→warm career arc and the favorite color on the highest-volume exam (FE).
- **v0.2.4 (2026-10-19):** Color finals — state PLS = deep bronze #6B5433 (ink retired as too dark); PS = deep pine #2E4B34 (terracotta retired; green-family continuity with FS). §2.1 table + notes and §2.3 updated; PS re-proofed on pine, NY on bronze.
- **v0.2.3 (2026-10-19):** PE rosette center opening enlarged to final spec (≈half the glyph diameter, reads as a ring seal). State-PLS field color review opened: ink flagged as possibly too dark; warm graphite / deep bronze / deep pine candidates documented in §2.1 — decision pending icon proofs.
- **v0.2.2 (2026-10-19):** D2 completed — triangle form = outline-with-dot △; per-exam glyph system adopted (△ for the surveying line · gear for FE · rosette seal for PE, Charlie's pick); color architecture settled: per-exam icon fields kept, all-teal icon set proofed and declined. §2.3 rewritten as the final icon spec.
- **v0.2.1 (2026-10-19):** D2 decided — Charlie picked C3 (accent field, paper serif monogram) plus a benchmark triangle; triangle color ruled **paper**, keeping every icon two-tone so the system survives the family swap. Family set proofed: PS / FE / PE siblings and the NY state-PLS pattern generated and QA-passed. §2.1 gains the state-PLS row; §2.3 records the icon system.
- **v0.2.0 (2026-10-18):** Charlie chose Style C "Calm Pro" from the Aesthetic Styles v0.1.0 board (mockups rendered all four styles in dark + light). §2 rewritten: hi-vis palette, stencil display type, and hazard motifs superseded; Calm Pro tokens, serif display, flat divider-based components adopted. §4 screenshot template updated. D2 icon reopened under the new direction. The v0.1.0 icon concepts remain on file in `fs-`

`exam-app-icons/` as history, not candidates.

- v0.1.0 (2026-10-14): hi-vis system defined; naming system, voice, and listing rules established (carried forward unchanged).

End of Brand Guide v0.2.6.